Lonnie Allen Watson

Software Architect · Healthcare Platforms · Cloud Modernization · Applied AI

Lincoln, RI · harlock123@gmail.com · harlock123.com · github.com/Harlock123 · linkedin.com/in/lonnie-watson-0bbb317

SUMMARY

Hands-on software architect with 24 years designing, building and modernizing healthcare information systems: behavioral health records, case and care management, claims payment and member-facing portals. Led engineering as CTO of Tidgewell Associates through its 2015 acquisition by Anthem (now Elevance Health), then carried its platforms into the enterprise.

Moved a decade-old client/server platform to Azure in three months. Today I build AI orchestrations on locally hosted LLMs and ship cross-platform .NET applications through fully automated build and release pipelines.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Architecture and modernization:** client/server to cloud, legacy UI to modern web, modular products that serve several clients without forking the code
- **Healthcare domain:** behavioral health EHR, case and care management, claims, authorizations, eligibility, Medicaid managed care (Pennsylvania HealthChoices)
- **Applied AI:** orchestrating locally hosted LLMs on self-built hardware; AI-assisted, agentic software delivery
- **Integration:** service layers that connect siloed systems and expose internal data safely to members and partners
- **Delivery:** CI/CD with built-in security scanning, code generation, reusable UI components
- **Leadership:** multi-state engineering teams, client requirements and proposals, mentoring, Certified ScrumMaster

EXPERIENCE

Elevance Health (formerly Anthem) and Tidgewell Associates — Smithfield, RI

Director and Domain Architect, Elevance Health — 2015 – present

Chief Technology Officer, Tidgewell Associates (acquired by Anthem in 2015) — 2002 – 2015

- Re-architected the CARES behavioral health platform (case management, claims payment, provider contracting) from client/server to Azure in three months. It went live in December 2019 with cloud database, document storage, authentication and deployment, and the client moved on to a second phase.
- Delivered a second CARES implementation as plug-in modules, so each client's features ship without forking the product.
- Built Anthem's first member-facing case management features (ASCA): web services that bring eligibility, care plans, authorizations, diagnoses, medications and care-team details out of many internal systems, plus forms members send straight to their care team.
- Led Tidgewell's engineering integration into Anthem after the 2015 acquisition, connecting previously siloed systems across teams.
- Automated build and release for a large business-integration portal: security scanning (Veracode, Checkmarx, Qualys), test matrices and per-environment deployment with Bamboo, Bitbucket and XL Deploy, scripted in PowerShell, Python and Bash.
- Wrote code generators that produce Blazor screens, shared components and REST endpoints from the database, and a data-access generator that predated Entity Framework.
- Principal architect for the Silverlight-to-HTML5 migration and for behavioral health record systems in New Jersey (NJ Cyber), Central Florida (IhSIS) and Integra Health Management (IntegraConnect).
- Built data warehousing, automated reporting and visualization for Pennsylvania counties throughout their HealthChoices implementation.
- Created reusable components used across products: an ad hoc point-and-click query and reporting tool, a form engine with branching logic and scoring, a data grid, a claims and authorization timeline, a Xamarin mobile app for care managers, and Electron desktop packaging.
- Led and mentored engineers across Rhode Island, Maryland, Pennsylvania, New Jersey and Florida; gathered requirements, wrote proposals and demonstrated products to clients.

HHM of Rhode Island

Warwick, RI

MCO Systems Administrator

1998 – 2002

- When the software bought for this behavioral health carve-out startup could not deliver, designed and built the in-house claims processing, payment and call center system the company ran on.
- Automated the link to the parent insurer's legacy authorization system and tied it to member and provider correspondence, closing a gap that predated the company.
- Built live call queuing and triage, and integrated SQL Server, Exchange and Linux file, print and web servers.

Earlier career

Software and field engineer for the POSitouch point-of-sale system (RDC Inc.), supporting hospitality clients worldwide with IBM, Compaq, Epson and touchscreen hardware partners. Before that, designed, built and supported business computer systems (MicroLimits Inc.).

INDEPENDENT WORK: AI AND ENGINEERING LAB

- Design and run AI orchestrations on self-built hardware, coordinating locally hosted LLMs through Ollama and LM Studio with no cloud dependency.
- Develop with agentic AI coding tools, directing them through architecture, implementation, testing and release.
- Shipped 14 cross-platform game recreations plus 7 tools and UI controls in C#, .NET and Avalonia. Every push builds and publishes self-contained executables for Windows, macOS and Linux on both x64 and ARM.
- Built harlock123.com, a portfolio that regenerates itself from GitHub data and redeploys to two hosts whenever a game publishes a release.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Python, PowerShell, Bash
- **Platforms and frameworks:** .NET, ASP.NET Core, Blazor, Angular, Avalonia, Electron
- **Cloud and DevOps:** Azure, Docker, GitHub Actions, Bamboo, Bitbucket, XL Deploy, Veracode, Checkmarx
- **Data:** SQL Server and Azure SQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MongoDB, data warehousing
- **AI:** Ollama, LM Studio, local LLM hosting and orchestration, agentic coding tools
- **Systems:** Windows Server, Linux administration, macOS, single-board computers (Raspberry Pi, Arduino)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified ScrumMaster (Scrum Alliance)